

5.6.4 DRM

Digital Rights Management is the idea of controlling the playing of music across hardware. Music bought online is often digitally encoded so that it cannot be shared. DRM has faced a lot of criticism; one example of DRM is Apple's FairPlay mechanism.

5.6.5 Equaliser

This is a tool that allows one to manually vary the emphasis on different frequency bands when an audio file is being played.



Most playback software comes with equalisers. The most common use of the equaliser is to increase the bass, treble, and mid-range frequencies; those very particular about what they want their music to sound like might use all the sliders.

5.6.6 MP3 Players

MP3 players are the most widely-sold personal media players. They are called so because they primarily play MP3 audio files, though other formats like WMA are often supported.



The iPod Nano

5.6.7 SD

A type of postage-stamp-sized Flash memory storage used for extending the memory of PMPs, cameras, and phones.

5.6.8 Skip Protection

A technology used in music players to prevent music from playing irregularly when the player is jerkily moved. This was an important feature for CD and MiniDisc players because they contained moving parts, and the read heads could be easily shaken. Skip protection usually works by compressing data to a memory buffer and then reading from it. This might result in lower quality because of the data loss during compression and decompression, but the benefit is uninterrupted music. Hard drive based PMPs do employ this